

Overview

Executive Summary

This report examines the use of Social Impact Assessment (SIA) in Singapore and identifies best practices from international case studies. The research reveals that Singapore does not currently have a formal, mandatory SIA framework, though it has implemented Heritage Impact Assessment (HIA) frameworks and various environmental assessment processes. In contrast, countries such as Australia, Canada, Finland, the Netherlands, and the United Kingdom have well-established SIA practices with detailed guidelines and regulatory frameworks. This review synthesizes findings through a detailed analysis of key literature and international case studies.

Research Question

What is the current state of SIA practice in Singapore?

This sub-question seeks to identify whether SIA is formally recognized, mandated, or informally practiced in Singapore's development processes, and to assess the existing institutional and regulatory landscape related to social impact evaluation.

What are the key features and best practices of SIA frameworks in selected international jurisdictions (e.g., Australia, Canada, Finland, Netherlands, UK), and how might they be adapted to Singapore's context?

This sub-question examines international SIA models to extract transferable principles, methodologies, and implementation strategies that could enhance social sustainability in Singapore's urban development.

Research Method

This study employs a qualitative research methodology rooted in an extensive review of both scholarly and grey literature. The research process comprises several key components: a literature search strategy that utilizes academic databases like Google Scholar and Scopus, along with government and international organization publications such as IAIA, IFC, and the World Bank, including case studies from Australia, Canada, Finland, the Netherlands, and the UK. The search employs keywords like "Social Impact Assessment," "SIA Singapore," "heritage impact assessment," "urban planning SIA," "SIA case studies," "SIA framework," "community engagement Singapore," and "social sustainability." Inclusion criteria specify documents published between 1990 and 2025,

encompassing peer-reviewed articles, official guidelines, case reports, and policy analyses focusing on SIA applications in urban development, infrastructure, housing, and heritage conservation. The analytical framework integrates thematic analysis to identify common themes such as regulatory approaches, community participation strategies, impact categories, and monitoring mechanisms, alongside a comparative analysis to evaluate practices across different jurisdictions and their relevance to Singapore. Limitations include dependency on publicly accessible sources, which may omit some internal or non-public SIA processes, and the restriction to materials in English only.